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Brand	Compaq	LG	Dart	PCS	Datamini	HCL	Zenith
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- Price:** Rs 60,000
- + High performance hardware
- OS not bundled

And the winner is...

We voted the HCL EzeeBee as the best choice in this gamut of systems since it offers good package for the price. It was a clear winner because of its excellent performance, great features, good upgrade options and a sound price. Performance wise, though the Dart Emerald Performance PC was on par with the HCL EzeeBee, it lost out when other factors such as features and upgrade options were taken into account. The Compaq S5010iL also equalled the EzeeBee in terms of features, but lost due to its dismal performance in most of the tests.

Coming to value for money, the competition heated up with the Zenith Value PC cutting the barrier with its terrific price, followed by the HCL EzeeBee with its excellent price-to-performance proposition. In the end, the HCL EzeeBee took the crown from



Buying Tips

- ✓ Have a clear idea about your requirements, so that you can buy a PC with specifications that meet your needs.
- ✓ All branded PC vendors offer a mere 128 MB of RAM in order to cut costs. If you plan to use Windows XP, we strongly recommend at least 256 MB.
- ✓ Choose a configuration that is as future-proof as possible. Look out for maximum expansion options such as PCI slots, an AGP slot, USB ports, etc.
- ✓ With all the new PCs offering the fastest processors and the latest graphic cards, thermal dynamics is of great importance. Hence, look out for additional cooling fans in the cabinet.
- ✓ As far as monitor size goes, choose a 17-inch monitor since they are pretty affordable these days. Similarly, don't settle for anything lesser than a 40 GB hard disk, running at 7200-rpm.
- ✓ Invest in a decent graphics card that gives optimal performance, if you plan to use your PC for multimedia, 3D content creation, games etc., rather than settling for the onboard graphics option.
- ✓ Check the various finance schemes available, but don't fall prey to the free gift schemes. Instead, take a look at the package offered.
- ✓ Make sure there's an authorised service centre close to you.

the Zenith Value PC by an extremely small margin of 0.1 units.

Both these PCs provide excellent value for money on their own terms, and are designed to meet the needs of two different segments. The Zenith Value PC is a system for people who intend to buy a computer that helps them with their basic office work, and provides some decent entertainment—all at a modest budget. On the other hand, the HCL EzeeBee offers enough power to run all applications, and also provides upgrade options at an acceptable price. 

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